

Rumours of a Raedon HD 4890 in the making, to beat the new GTX series, are doing the rounds

Sony launches two new touchscreen cameras — the DSC-T90 and DSC-T900 which are capable of 720p video recording

TRIED & TESTED

ASUS P6T Deluxe

A well thought of X58 board

The ASUS P6T Deluxe is one of the first X58 motherboards from ASUS to support the new Core i7 processors. We got an Intel Core i7 965 Extreme and were really anxious to test and see how good is this board.

The layout of this board is good and just as a motherboard should be. You have six DIMM slots next to the LGA 1366 CPU socket alternatively highlighted with black and orange. The P6T supports up to 24 GB of DDR3 RAM. The CMOS battery is at the corner of the motherboard next to the DIMM slots and near that is a CPU over-volting jumper.

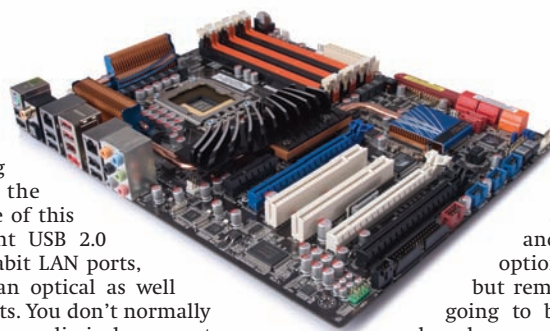
There are also six SATA ports that are positioned pretty nicely as to not interfere with the graphics card, and next to that are two SAS (Serial Attached SCSI) ports that can be connected in RAID with the Marvell 88E6320-TFJ2 controller. The SAS ports can be used for server hard drives and are easily distinguished as they are orange in colour. Even though this motherboard has three PCIe x16 slots, it supports only 2-way SLI as the second and third slot are too close to each other.

The northbridge heatsink has an interesting design and ASUS calls this Wind-Flow Thermal Design. The design of the northbridge heatsink is such that it acts as an air duct off the CPU heatsink. But that is only if you are using a top down heatsink and not others, such as heatpipe designs.

A few interesting things on the back-panel side of this board are eight USB 2.0 ports, two Gigabit LAN ports, FireWire and an optical as well as SPDIF outputs. You don't normally see both of these audio jacks present on the same board. There is also only a single PS2 port for those who still like the traditional mouse or keyboard.

The thing we like about ASUS boards is the micro switches that come along with it — one to power on/off and the other to reset and these are also present in the P6T Deluxe. Another small little catchy feature is the ASUS logo that's present on the southbridge; this lights up when powered on. It definitely will impress those with transparent side panels on their cabinets.

To test the performance of this board we used the Intel Core i7 965, 3 GB of Kingston DDR3 RAM (PC3 16000) and an ASUS GTX285 TOP. The results were very good. We got great scores in PC Mark 05, 3D Mark 06, Maxxon Cinebench and even with WinRar. When it came down to games, it did great with Doom 3 and FarCry, but when it came to Crysis there wasn't a performance jump as we expected. Crysis gave us just about a playable FPS result in our benchmark which was similar to a good P45 board.



Overall, this board has a great layout and even has the option for 2-way SLI, but remember if you are going to buy this motherboard you will have to do a complete overhaul of your PC, as with the motherboard, you will need to purchase new RAM and a new processor. But if you are going to build a PC and want to go the Core i7 way then we would say go ahead and get this board.

Specifications:

Chipset - Intel X58 / ICH10R, RAM - 6 x DIMM, Max. 24 GB, 3 x PCIe 2.0 x16 (at x16/x16/x1 or x16/x8/x8 mode), 1 x PCIe x4, 2 x PCI

Ratings

Features: 8
Performance: 8.5
Build quality: 9
Value for money: 6.5
Overall: 8

Contact: ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: +91-22-6766 8800 / 1-800-2090365
Email: media_india@asus.com
Web site: www.asus.in
Price: Rs. 20,500

Plustek SmartOffice PS286

A speedy scanner

Most companies usually opt for MFDs rather than scanners these days as that single device does include scanning capabilities. However, the ones with good quality scanning come at a higher price. Plustek wants to show how good and fast scanning is possible on a compact scanner such as its SmartOffice PS286

The scanner is a third of the size of a typical MFD and is not a typical flatbed scanner, but looks more like a printer with a top loading tray. There is a



total of three buttons on this device, one to scan and two to scroll between the functions which are displayed with the numbers from 1 – 9 in between the buttons. Though this device is compact, it does have many features under its hood, but these are controlled by the software provided.

Options that are available are: scan and open, copy, email, file, OCR, scan and save and BCR which can be set from the software provided with the additional options of selecting the image output format, the dpi for which to scan and also the options for colour, greyscale and black and white. This slot-feeding type scanner has double-sided scanning which is something that will not be found with all MFDs.

For a single colour scan it took just 10 sec and under half of that for greyscale at 200 dpi; the image quality was not perfect, but definitely above average. A 600 dpi colour scan took a total of 40 sec, but for some reason the output was not that great and we noticed some yellow strips across the image. The scanner was noisier than

usual with these settings, as if it was stressing itself for this one scan. A duplex colour scan took less than half a minute which is really quick. The performance of this scanner is impressive, but a price tag of Rs. 25,000 for this scanner is not justified. It would be wiser to spend on an MFD which allows you to scan too.

Specifications:

Max. Resolutions: 600 dpi, ADF capacity: 50 sheets, Net Weight: 1.66 kg

Ratings

Features: 8
Performance: 8
Build quality: 8
Value for money: 3
Overall: 6.5

Contact: Fujisan Technologies Ltd
Phone: +91-99875 67015
Email: sales@fujisan.co.in
Web site: www.fujisan.co.in
Price: Rs. 25,000